



Frost & Sullivan & TERI has felicitated us with the Challengers Award for large business process sector and Jury special mention award for water-saving initiatives.

SUSTAINABILITY COMPLIANCE IS ALWAYS AN ISSUE WITH THE INVESTORS. HOW DOES VARDHMAN MANAGE THIS?

At Vardhman, it has been our consistent endeavour, for over five decades, to enhance the positive impacts of our textile operations as much as possible. Sustainability is not a fad for us, rather it is an ongoing journey towards holistic excellence, and the sustainability mind-set is deeply embedded across our organisation from boardroom to shop floor.

We consistently work towards bettering our performance – incrementally and through trailblazing innovations. However, in our quest to find our edge, we also ensure we don't let our guard down. Our vision is to attain accelerated economic growth while rejuvenating the planet and its resources, and deliver large, positive socio-economic value to all stakeholders.

ARE THERE ANY COLLABORATIONS DONE IN ACHIEVING SUSTAINABILITY?

We have collaborated with GAP & ckinetics, and participated in one of their Global initiatives viz. "Women + Water" for upliftment of Rural Women as also Safe and sustainable water access to the Rural communities. Additionally, we are registered for Clean By Design with GAP, PVH & Target to incorporate world's best practices in our ETP Operations and Safe Chemical Management.

WHAT ARE THE KEY TAKEAWAYS FROM THE SUSTAINABILITY APPROACH OF YOUR ORGANIZATION?

Vardhman has always kept sustainability at the core of its business strategies. We have reduced our specific water consumption by 30 per cent, moved towards cleaner agro residue- based fuels, adopted latest technologies to reduce emissions, besides achieving substantial reduction in freshwater consumption.

Our research and development teams in collaboration with production and sustainability teams are continuously working to switch over to 100 per cent environmental friendly dyes and chemicals.

Our vision is to stay ahead of the prescribed standards. We are constantly improving our supply chains to effectively reduce secondary emissions from our manufacturing. Sustainable sourcing of raw materials is another strong aspect of Sustainability at Vardhman with certifications from domestic and international agencies such as the BCI, GRS etc.



WE CONSISTENTLY WORK TOWARDS BETTERING OUR PERFORMANCE – INCREMENTALLY AND THROUGH TRAILBLAZING INNOVATIONS

Climate change is a collective challenge for the human kind. The fashion industry contributes to around 10% of global greenhouse gas emissions and as a responsible member of this industry, at Vardhman, we are actively contributing to help mitigate this challenge by reducing emissions from our operations.

Under the Perform, Achieve and Trade (PAT) Scheme rolled out by the National Mission for Enhanced Energy Efficiency, (as part of the National Action Plan on Climate Change to incentivize Energy Efficiency by awarding tradable certificates to performers), Vardhman Fabrics received the Best Achiever Award in PAT cycle I (2012-2015) and retained its position among the top three rank holders in PAT cycle-II (2016-2019).

Additionally, our continuous efforts are helping to sequester several thousand tons of CO2 per annum.

DO YOU HAVE THE ESG APPROACH AT VARDHMAN? HOW DO YOU IMPLEMENT IT?

Even before the term ESG was coined, Vardhman has been actively working towards all three – Environment, Social Responsibility & Governance. However, we haven't been as conscious as regards disclosures in the public domain.

We have now started standardization of our public disclosures as per leading international standards such as GRI, SASB, TCFD, UN SDG etc. Our team is focused on constantly improving our data availability in the public domain in the area of Environmental Social Governance (ESG).

We are aiming to achieve higher ESG ratings by international agencies in the years to come. As the business environment is getting more and more competitive, we aspire to be a front runner in the global sustainability space. Our detailed ESG profile is published and can be accessed on our website.

WHAT ARE YOU DOING IN REDUCING WASTE AND USING RENEWABLE ENERGY?

We have covered a long distance in improving energy efficiency and most of our manufacturing facilities now serve as a benchmark for the evaluation agencies including the Bureau of energy efficiency. The targets fixed by the government agency for energy saving and reducing specific energy consumption are based on the norms already achieved by manufacturing units of Vardhman.

Our professionals have participated with the government in the standardization of benchmarks for the textile industry by providing effective inputs.

We are continuously marching ahead to reduce consumption and lower our reliance on conventional sources of power. We have installed solar power systems of 13.1 MW in two of our units with a capacity to generate 243 million kWh of green power. We have also installed solar street lights in several villages under our CSR initiatives. Further, we have installed solar water heaters in staff colonies and kitchens across the Group.

We also have a biogas plant with a capacity to produce 7 MT/day of gas which is used for cooking.

In our boilers, we are using husk as a biofuel. We have dedicated teams working on various dimensions of sustainability operations – air, water, energy, products & processes, besides social responsibility.